

LIGHT MACHINE-GUNS (1902–15)

Trench warfare and stagnant lines were the norm on World War I battlefields, and the development of easily carried machine-guns became a necessity for raids and the strengthening of positions under fire. Some light machine-guns were developed strictly for use in aircraft, for which weight was a primary design consideration. During the first years of its use, the light machine-gun proved to be invaluable both as a defensive and offensive weapon, thereby leading to its further refinement as World War I progressed.

▲ MADSEN MEDIUM LMG

Date 1902

Origin Denmark

Barrel 23in (58.4cm)

Caliber 7 × 57mm

Developed by Julius Rasmussen and Theodor Schouboe, the Madsen was introduced into service in 1902. It had an effective cyclic rate of 450 rounds per minute and was noted for its reliability. It was, however, expensive to manufacture and therefore had a limited clientele.

